3.5 Methods of Printing

3.5.1 Block Printing

Block printing is the ancient method of printing designs on the textile material by hand. It is the simplest of the printing methods. In this method, the desired design is carved on a wooden or metal block. The fabric is pinned on a table which is firm, strong and withstands the pressure of printing. The top is made of metal with a resilient surface made of artificial leather. The wooden block is stamped in the print paste or applied on the surface of the block. The block is stamped firmly on the selected part of the fabric. This process is repeated to print the required length of fabric. Multicoloured designs require separate blocks for each colour. Block printing is done mainly in decorative pieces or in expensive linens for upholstery purposes.



Figure 3.1 Block Prining Blocks



Figure 3.2 Printing Paste



Figure 3.3 Application of Colour to the Block



Figure 3.4 Block Printing



Figure 3.5 Block Printed Fabric

Advantages

- Simplest method of printing
- Handmade art
- No special printing equipment required

Disadvantages

- Tedious and time consuming process
- Expensive
- Irregular colour shade
- Overall production is low
- Carving of blocks is difficult and laborious.

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